

V16 Virtual Artificial Intelligence Team

Description & Eligibility

Teams will design and present an integrated artificial intelligence (AI) solution for a subscription-based SaaS company using the official BPA case study and data pack. Teams will use generative and analytical AI tools to interpret the data and produce professional artifacts across four functional areas: Finance, Information Technology (IT), Business/Marketing, and Digital Media Design. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Any middle level, secondary, or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. A team will consist of 2–4 contestants. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. Teams who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

LoopToLearn – An AI-Assisted EdTech Subscription Platform. Your team has been hired as AI strategy consultants for *LoopToLearn*, a five-year-old subscription-based SaaS company that provides AI-assisted tutoring and study-skills coaching for high school and early-college students. *LoopToLearn* offers three subscription tiers (Student, Family, and School District) and is preparing for a Series B funding round. The leadership team has provided your firm with an official BPA case study and data pack containing financial records, IT infrastructure logs, customer/marketing data, and current brand assets. Your team must use AI tools to analyze the data pack and produce four integrated deliverables that demonstrate ethical, responsible, and reproducible AI use across Finance, IT, Business/Marketing, and Digital Media Design.

Deliverables

- Finance Artifact – A two-page decision brief incorporating a subscription revenue forecast, a churn analysis, and a Series B funding recommendation (PDF, two pages maximum)
- IT Artifact – A two-page infrastructure and security brief incorporating a cloud-scaling plan, a data-privacy/FERPA risk assessment, and an AI model selection recommendation (PDF, two pages maximum)
- Business/Marketing Artifact – A two-page brief incorporating a customer segmentation analysis and a go-to-market campaign brief targeting the Family and School District tiers (PDF, two pages maximum)
- Digital Media Design Artifact – AI-assisted brand refresh deliverable including a one-page visual identity sheet (logo treatment, color, typography) and a 30-second promotional video storyboard for the campaign (PDF, with video link embedded)
- AI Use Log – A single combined document listing every AI tool used, the prompts issued, the date/time of each interaction, and a short note on how the team verified and edited each output (PDF, no page limit)

Page limit and format specifications: Artifacts 1, 2, and 3 are limited to two (2) pages each, maximum. The two-page limit is inclusive of all charts, tables, and visuals; the Works Cited page is excluded from the count. All artifact reports must follow the report format defined in the Style & Reference Manual. The Digital Media Design Artifact (Artifact 4) follows its own format described above and is not subject to the two-page limit.

Competition Notes

- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register teams for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>
 - Click on the “Conferences” tab and then select the “2027 National Virtual Events”
 - There will be a \$20 fee for each team entry (invoiced during event registration)
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after member registration

- The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2026
- Teams participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible
- Only the team captain should complete the submission

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
Submit a URL to all the following in one PDF: 1. Finance Artifact 2. IT Artifact 3. Business/Marketing Artifact 4. Digital Media Design Artifact 5. AI Usage Log 6. Works Cited 7. BPA Release Form(s) 8. AI Usage and Documentation Form	V16-TeamID.pdf	January 15, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Demonstrate understanding of AI concepts, capabilities, and limitations
2. Apply AI tools to finance, IT operations, marketing, and digital media design
3. Use structured case study data to drive evidence-based decisions
4. Design AI workflows and prompts that are structured and reproducible
5. Demonstrate ethical and responsible AI use, including bias mitigation, transparency, data privacy, and security
6. Communicate complex technical information to non-technical stakeholders
7. Produce professional written, visual, and strategic deliverables
8. Demonstrate teamwork, project management, and decision-making skills
9. Apply principles of design and rules for proper layout in developing business publications for multiple screens and printing situations
10. Use principles of design, layout, and typography in media and user experience design
11. Demonstrate effective persuasive and informative communication and presentation skills

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Follow the Report format located in the *Style & Reference Manual*. (Note: no Title Page is required.) Header information on the first page of the report should be as follows: Contestant ID Number (Sender's ID Number - XXXXXXXX), Edna Renick (Recipient's Name), Administrative Support Department (Recipient's Department), and Current Date.
- Submit all artifacts, Works Cited, AI Use Log, BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form in one combined PDF file to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on January 15, 2027.
- Round One consists of two components: (1) an online objective test covering AI concepts, ethics, and applied use cases, completed individually by each team member, and (2) the technical project submission described above. Team Round One scores combine the average team test score with the technical project score.
- Round Two is a live virtual presentation and Q&A. Advisors of qualifying teams will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Teams will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.

- Teams with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase. See <https://bpa.org/nlc/virtual-competitions-and-nlc-national-showcase/> for more information.
- Generative AI tools may be used to create deliverables, but every AI-assisted output must be reviewed, edited, and verified by a team member. The AI Use Log must accurately reflect this process.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered members and/or those missing team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves and any AI tools used, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. In-text citations are required throughout all papers.
- It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines. Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will not be returned and will not be available at NLC.

V16 Artificial Intelligence Team

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the disqualification.				

Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF with all four (4) functional-area artifacts, the AI Use Log, Works Cited formatted according to the Style & Reference Manual, BPA Release Form(s) and the AI Usage and Documentation Form. Artifacts 1, 2, and 3 each comply with the two-page limit and follow the report format in the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> .				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Financial Artifact	Analysis contains significant errors, misreads the data pack, or draws conclusions unsupported by the numbers.	Analysis is mostly accurate and reflects the data pack with minor gaps in interpretation.	Analysis is highly accurate, demonstrates strong financial reasoning, and aligns precisely with the data pack.	/20
Data Analysis Accuracy				
Revenue Forecast Quality	Forecast lacks supporting logic, omits key subscription metrics (MRR, ARR, churn), or is presented without context.	Forecast addresses core subscription metrics and provides a reasonable model with stated assumptions.	Forecast is well-modeled, clearly visualized, and tied directly to subscription-tier behavior and growth scenarios.	/20
Series B Memo	Recommendation is vague, unsupported, or disconnected from the financial analysis.	Recommendation is reasonable and references the analysis, with adequate justification.	Recommendation is decisive, evidence-based, and clearly tied to forecast outcomes and investor concerns.	/20
AI Use & Verification	AI outputs appear unedited, contain hallucinated figures, or are not verified against the data pack.	AI outputs are reviewed and corrected, with verification noted in the AI Use Log.	AI outputs are carefully verified, cross-checked, and improved by the team beyond the initial AI output.	/20
Concision & Synthesis	Brief is cluttered or exceeds two pages; key points are buried or the page limit is not respected.	Brief fits two pages and covers the required elements with reasonable prioritization.	Brief makes excellent use of two pages, surfacing only the most decision-relevant insights with clear prioritization.	/20

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

AI Artifact	Cloud-scaling plan is vague, omits key components, or does not address subscription growth.	Cloud-scaling plan is reasonable, addresses scaling needs, and identifies appropriate services.	Cloud-scaling plan is detailed, well-justified, and demonstrates strong technical reasoning.	/20
Infrastructure Plan				
Data Privacy & FERPA	Risk assessment is missing key student-data considerations or misapplies privacy frameworks.	Risk assessment covers core FERPA considerations and identifies major risks.	Risk assessment is thorough, prioritizes risks, and includes clear mitigation strategies.	/20
AI Model Selection	Model recommendation lacks rationale or selects an inappropriate model for the use case.	Model recommendation is reasonable and includes basic justification.	Model recommendation is well-justified, addresses trade-offs (cost, latency, bias), and aligns with the data pack.	/20
AI Use & Verification	AI outputs appear unedited or include unverified technical claims.	AI outputs are reviewed and corrected, with verification noted in the AI Use Log.	AI outputs are rigorously verified, with technical claims supported by cited sources or team analysis.	/20
Concision & Synthesis	Brief is cluttered or exceeds two pages; key points are buried or the page limit is not respected.	Brief fits two pages and covers the required elements with reasonable prioritization.	Brief makes excellent use of two pages, using tables and visuals efficiently to convey dense technical content.	/20
Business/Marketing Artifact	Segmentation is unclear, not data-driven, or fails to distinguish meaningful customer groups.	Segmentation is data-informed and identifies the Family and District tiers with reasonable distinctions.	Segmentation is insightful, well-supported by the data pack, and reveals actionable customer behavior patterns.	/20
Customer Segmentation				
Campaign Strategy	Campaign brief lacks a clear strategy, target, or measurable goals.	Campaign brief includes a defined target, channels, and goals appropriate to the tiers.	Campaign brief is strategically sharp, tightly targeted, and includes measurable KPIs tied to subscription growth.	/20
Messaging & Audience Fit	Messaging is generic or poorly aligned with the Family and District audiences.	Messaging is appropriate for each target audience and reasonably differentiated.	Messaging is highly tailored, emotionally resonant, and clearly differentiated by audience and tier.	/20

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

AI Use & Verification	AI-generated copy or analysis appears unedited or includes unsupported claims.	AI outputs are reviewed, edited, and verified for accuracy and tone.	AI outputs are substantially refined, fact-checked, and improved with original team input.	/20
Concision & Synthesis	Brief is cluttered or exceeds two pages; key points are buried or the page limit is not respected.	Brief fits two pages and covers the required elements with reasonable prioritization.	Brief makes excellent use of two pages, presenting segmentation and campaign strategy with clarity and focus.	/20
Digital Media Design Artifact	Brand identity sheet is inconsistent, unpolished, or does not address logo, color, and typography together.	Brand identity sheet is cohesive and covers logo, color, and typography clearly.	Brand identity sheet is highly polished, distinctive, and demonstrates intentional design choices.	/20
Visual Identity Quality				
Storyboard Quality	Storyboard is unclear, lacks visual structure, or does not tell a coherent 30-second story.	Storyboard is clear, organized, and communicates the campaign concept in 30 seconds.	Storyboard is creative, well-paced, and visually compelling, with strong message-to-image alignment.	/20
Brand Consistency	Brand elements are applied inconsistently between the identity sheet and the storyboard.	Brand elements are consistently applied across both deliverables.	Brand elements are flawlessly consistent and reinforce a unified, recognizable identity.	/20
AI Use & Verification	AI-generated visuals appear unedited, off-brand, or are not credited in the AI Use Log.	AI-generated visuals are reviewed, refined, and credited appropriately.	AI-generated visuals are substantially refined by the team and integrated with original design work.	/20
AI Use Log & Ethics	Log is missing tools, prompts, or dates; entries are inconsistent across deliverables. Log is missing tools, prompts, or dates; entries are inconsistent across deliverables.	Log records each tool, prompt, and date used for the four artifacts. Log records each tool, prompt, and date used for the four artifacts.	Log is thorough, organized by artifact, and includes verification notes for every entry. Log is thorough, organized by artifact, and includes verification notes for every entry.	/20
Log Completeness				
Prompt Quality	Prompts are vague, single-shot, or not reproducible.	Prompts are structured, purposeful, and could be reproduced by another user.	Prompts demonstrate iterative refinement, role/context framing, and a clear workflow.	/20
Ethics & Responsible Use	Log does not address bias, transparency, privacy, or human oversight.	Log addresses ethical considerations and identifies at least one risk and mitigation.	Log demonstrates a strong ethical framework, including bias checks, transparency, privacy review, and clear human-in-the-loop oversight.	/20

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

Integration & Communication	The four artifacts read as disconnected projects with conflicting assumptions.	The four artifacts share common assumptions and reference the same case-study facts.	The four artifacts integrate tightly, building toward a single, coherent strategy for the company.	/20
Cross-Functional Alignment				
Writing & Editing Quality	Artifacts contain frequent grammar, spelling, or formatting errors.	Artifacts contain few errors and are generally well-edited.	Artifacts are polished, professional, and read as if produced by a consulting team.	/20
Visual & Layout Quality	Layout is cluttered, inconsistent, or hard to follow across artifacts.	Layout is clean and consistent across artifacts.	Layout is highly polished, visually consistent, and supports the message across all four deliverables.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/50

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Presentation	Team struggles with communication, organization, or topic understanding, making the presentation unclear or disengaging.	Team communicates clearly, stays organized, and demonstrates solid understanding of the topic.	Team excels in delivery, presents with clarity and enthusiasm, and shows deep understanding of the topic.	/20
Explanation of AI Solution	Explanation of the four artifacts and how they integrate is unclear or incomplete.	Clearly explains each artifact and how the four areas connect to the AI solution.	Thoroughly explains all four artifacts and how they integrate into a single, coherent AI strategy.	/20
AI Tools & Workflow	AI tools and prompting workflow are not clearly identified or explained.	Provides a clear explanation of the AI tools, prompts, and workflow used.	Offers detailed and thoughtful explanation of tools, prompts, and verification workflow, showing strong understanding.	/20
Ethical & Responsible Use	Team does not address ethics, bias, privacy, or human oversight in the presentation.	Team addresses ethical considerations and identifies at least one risk and mitigation.	Team articulates a strong ethical framework, including bias, transparency, privacy, and human-in-the-loop oversight.	/20
Team Roles	Roles of team members are vague or missing, with little connection to project outcomes.	Clearly explains the roles and contributions of each team member.	Provides a comprehensive and engaging explanation of team roles, collaboration, and decision-making.	/20
Structure & Flow	Presentation lacks organization and is difficult to follow.	Presentation is well organized and flows logically.	Presentation is highly engaging, with excellent structure and smooth transitions.	/20
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/20
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/155

FINANCIAL SERVICES

100	Fundamental Accounting
105	College Accounting
110	Advanced Accounting
115	Advanced College Accounting
125	Payroll Accounting
135	Managerial Accounting
145	Banking and Finance
150	Financial Analyst Team
155	Economic Trends Research Individual
160	Economic Trends Research Team
165	Personal Financial Management
190	Financial Services Concepts (Open)